

ELPA21 Task Practice

Student Packet · Grades 9–12 · Emerging and Progressing

Eight practice tasks across the four language domains — listening, speaking, reading, and writing — built in the format of the ELPA21 assessment. Each task gives you something to look at or listen to, a strategy to use, a job to do, and a way to push further when you finish.

Original practice content written for Laurel High School and modeled on ELPA21 task types. Not an ELPA21 publication and not a released test form.

Name _____ Class period _____ Date _____

How to use this packet

- **Work in order or by domain.** Each task stands alone. Your teacher may assign one a week or a full domain at a time.
- **Use the supports.** Sentence frames and word banks are there to be used, not to be avoided. Using a frame well is a skill the test rewards.
- **Say it before you write it.** Every writing task gets better after you say the sentence out loud to a partner first.
- **Your first language helps.** Take notes, plan, and think in Spanish when that is faster. Produce the final answer in English.
- **Finish with the stretch.** The last box in every task is where the growth is.

What each domain asks of you

Domain	On the test you will...	In this packet
Listening	Hear a passage or set of directions once or twice and answer without seeing the words	Tasks 5 and 6
Speaking	Record a response to a prompt, a picture, or a set of data	Tasks 3 and 4

Reading	Read a passage, often with a graph or chart, and answer questions	Tasks 7 and 8
Writing	Write a paragraph, a message, or a set of questions for a purpose	Tasks 1 and 2

Task 1

Grades 9–12	School Schedule	Writing
Task	Construct a Claim	
Read	Notice from the student council The student council is asking the district to move the first bell from 7:45 a.m. to 8:30 a.m. Buses would run later, the school day would end at 4:15 p.m., and after-school practice would start after that.	
Teach	You are writing to persuade. A strong claim tells the reader what you think and why. Check your work. Make sure you • State your opinion in the first sentence • Give at least two reasons • Use one detail from the notice • Write for adults who will read this at a school board meeting	
Write	Should the school day start later? Write one paragraph. State your claim, give two reasons, and explain one problem the change might cause.	
Support	Sentence frames I believe the school day should / should not start later because ____. One reason is _____. Another reason is _____. Some people say _____, but _____. For these reasons, the district should _____. Word bank schedule · bell · transportation · attendance · alert · practice · shift · impact · propose · oppose	

Stretch

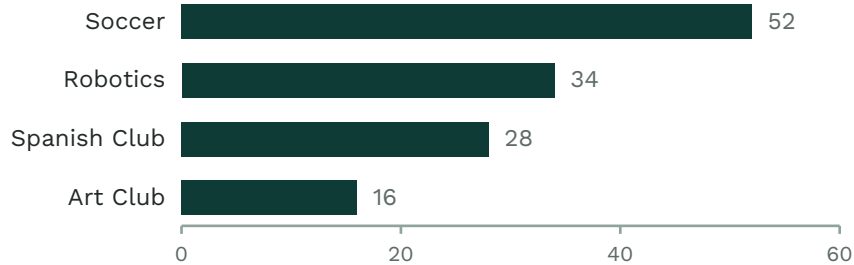
- 1 Read your paragraph out loud and record it on your Chromebook.
- 2 Write the opposite claim. Which paragraph is stronger, and why?
- 3 Interview two students and add their reasons to your paragraph.

Task 2

Grades 9–12	Email	Writing
Task	Respond to a Message	
Read	To: you@laurelschools.org From: Marisol Subject: Missed the lab Hi! You were absent Thursday, so you missed the density lab in Ms. Pope's class. We worked in pairs and I still need a partner for the write-up. Can you meet before school on Tuesday, or is lunch better? Also, do you want me to bring my data table so you can copy the measurements? Marisol	
Teach	You are writing a reply to a classmate. The tone is friendly, but the message still has a job to do: answer every question that was asked. Check your work. Make sure you • Greet the person and thank them • Answer both questions — when to meet, and the data table • Ask one question of your own • Close with your name	
Write	Write your reply to Marisol. To: marisol@laurelschools.org Subject: Re: Missed the lab	

Support	Sentence frames Hi Marisol, thank you for ____. I can meet ____ because ____. Yes / No, please ____ the data table. One question I have is ____. See you _____,
Stretch	1 Write the same message to Ms. Pope. What changes when the reader is a teacher? 2 Write an email asking a teacher for extra help, using a subject line that says exactly what you need. 3 Trade emails with a partner and answer theirs.

Task 3

Grades 9–12	Club Sign-Ups	Speaking										
Task	Observe and Report											
Look	Students signed up for after-school clubs during the first week of school. The graph shows how many students joined each club.  <table><thead><tr><th>Club</th><th>Number of Students</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>Soccer</td><td>52</td></tr><tr><td>Robotics</td><td>34</td></tr><tr><td>Spanish Club</td><td>28</td></tr><tr><td>Art Club</td><td>16</td></tr></tbody></table>		Club	Number of Students	Soccer	52	Robotics	34	Spanish Club	28	Art Club	16
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Teach	You are reporting what the data shows. Say the numbers, then say what they mean. A report is not an opinion — it stays with the evidence. • Name what the graph measures • Give the largest and the smallest • Compare two clubs using a number • Say one conclusion you can draw											
Speak	Tell your partner what the graph shows. Use complete sentences. Then record yourself and listen once. Sentence frames The graph shows ____. The club with the most students is ____, with ____ students. ____ has ____ more students than ____. One conclusion I can draw is ____.											
Stretch	1 Which club would you join, and why? Give two reasons. 2 Survey ten classmates about a topic of your choice and draw your own graph. 3 Explain your graph to someone at home in your first language, then in English.											

Task 4

Grades 9–12	Work and School	Speaking
Task	State an Opinion	
Listen	Your teacher will read this to you. Prompt The school board is considering a rule that every senior must complete twenty hours of paid or unpaid work experience before graduation. Students could work at a business, volunteer at a nonprofit, or help at a family business.	
Teach	You will state an opinion and defend it. Say what you think, then give two reasons. End by saying what you want to happen. • Agree or disagree clearly — do not say 'maybe' • Give two different reasons, not the same reason twice • Use one example from your own life or someone you know • Speak for at least one minute	
Speak	Do you agree or disagree with the twenty-hour rule? State your opinion and give at least two reasons. Sentence frames I agree / disagree with the rule because ____. First, _____. Second, _____. For example, my _____ works at _____ and _____. That is why I think the board should _____.	
Stretch	1 Ask an adult who works in your community what they learned from their first job. Report back in three sentences. 2 Take the opposite side and argue it for one minute. 3 Name two places in Laurel where a student could complete the twenty hours.	

Task 5

Grades 9–12	Following a Procedure	Listening
Task	Follow Instructions	
Listen	Close your packet or cover this page. Your teacher will read a set of instructions aloud twice. Listen for the order of the steps and for words you do not know. Listen for How many steps are there? Which step comes first, and which comes last? What words tell you the order? Is there a step you could not do?	
Teach	Do not look at the words while you listen. Take notes with pictures, numbers, or your first language. You may ask for one repetition.	
Speak	Answer your teacher's questions out loud. Then retell the steps in order using your notes. Sentence frames First, you _____. Next, you _____. After that, _____. Finally, _____. The step I did not understand was _____. This is similar to _____ that I have made before.	
Write	Write the steps in order in your own words.	

Stretch

- 1 Write instructions for something you know how to make or do at home. Use four steps.
- 2 Read your instructions to a partner without showing them. Can they repeat them back?
- 3 Watch a two-minute how-to video with the sound on and captions off. Write the steps.

Task 6

Grades 9–12	Science Lecture	Listening
Task	Academic Lecture or Discussion	
Listen	Cover this page. Your teacher will read a short science passage aloud twice. You will answer questions without seeing the text. Listen for What is the passage mainly about? Two or three facts you can repeat One word you want defined Why the topic matters	
Teach	Academic listening is different from conversation. The speaker will not repeat themselves or check on you. Hold the main idea first, then collect details around it.	
Speak	Answer your teacher's questions. Then give a thirty-second summary. Sentence frames The passage was mainly about _____. One fact I remember is _____. The word _____ probably means _____. This is important because _____.	
Write	Write three facts you heard. _____ _____ _____ _____	
Stretch	1 Research one more fact about the animal and add it to your notes. 2 Write four questions you would ask a wildlife biologist. 3 Find another endangered species in Mississippi and compare the two in three sentences.	

Task 7

Grades 9–12	Career Pathways	Reading
Task	Extended Informational Set	
Read	Choosing a Pathway at Pine Belt High School Every student at Pine Belt High School chooses a career pathway before eleventh grade. A pathway is a group of classes that build on each other and lead to a certificate, a college program, or a job after graduation. The largest pathway is health sciences, where students learn medical terminology and practice clinical skills in a lab. Welding students earn hours toward an industry certificate and often work part-time before they graduate. The computer networking pathway is newer, and the automotive pathway has run at the school for more than twenty years. Ms. Ruiz, who teaches health sciences, worked as a respiratory therapist for nine years. Mr. Landry, the welding instructor, still takes contract jobs in the summer. Both teachers say the students who succeed are the ones who ask questions early. Students enrolled in each pathway Health Sciences 58 Welding 41 Automotive 33 Computer Networking 19 0 20 40 60	
Teach	This is an informational set: a passage and a graph that go together. Some answers are in the words, some are in the graph, and some need both.	

Write	Answer at least five questions in complete sentences. 1 According to the graph, which pathway has the most students? 2 Who teaches that pathway, and what did she do before teaching? 3 Which pathway is mentioned in the passage as the newest? 4 How many more students are in welding than in automotive? 5 What is a pathway, in your own words? 6 Which pathway would you choose, and what in the passage or graph supports your choice?
Stretch	1 Find out which pathways your own school offers and how many students are in each. 2 Write a short description of a pathway your school does not have yet. 3 Choose one pathway and research two jobs it leads to, including what they pay.

Task 8

Grades 9–12	Biography	Reading
Task	Short Paragraph	
Read	Ida B. Wells Ida B. Wells was born into slavery in Holly Springs, Mississippi, in 1862, months before emancipation reached the state. She lost both parents to a yellow fever epidemic when she was a teenager and took work as a teacher to keep her younger brothers and sisters together. Wells moved to Memphis, where she became a journalist and part owner of a newspaper. After three of her friends were lynched in 1892, she began investigating such killings across the South, gathering names, dates, and details, and publishing what she found. Her reporting made her a target; her newspaper office was destroyed and she could not safely return to Memphis. She kept writing from Chicago, lectured in Britain and across the United States, campaigned for women's right to vote, and was among the founders of the NAACP. She is remembered today as one of the most rigorous investigative journalists of her century.	
Teach	Read the passage twice. The first time, find out who the person is. The second time, underline what she did and why it mattered.	
Write	Answer at least five questions. 1 Give three facts about Ida B. Wells. 2 Why did she start teaching as a teenager? 3 What did she investigate, and how did she do it? 4 What happened to her newspaper office? 5 What does the word <i>rigorous</i> mean in the last sentence? 6 Why do you think she kept writing after she was threatened?	

Stretch

- 1 Write four questions you would ask Ida B. Wells.
- 2 Research another journalist or activist from Mississippi and compare them in a paragraph.
- 3 Write a short news article about something happening at your school. Include a headline, a first sentence with the main facts, and one quotation.

Can-do self-check

Mark where you are after each task. Come back at the end of the quarter and mark it again in a different color.

Domain	I can...	Not yet	With help	On my own
Listening	I can follow spoken directions with several steps.			
Listening	I can answer questions about a passage I only heard.			
Speaking	I can describe what a graph or table shows.			
Speaking	I can state an opinion and give two reasons.			
Reading	I can find answers in a passage and in a graph together.			
Reading	I can figure out a new word from the sentences around it.			
Writing	I can write a paragraph with a claim and reasons.			
Writing	I can write a message that answers every question asked.			